

Title: Plat Support main looking for tips to mid/top as a terrible cs/wave management player

Score:

--- POST CONTENT ---

Hey Everyone!

I have played League on and off since 2014 but for the past 5 years I've pretty much stuck to support for ranked and always sit around gold-plat. I've become pretty good at map awareness/vision control but I am pretty worthless at keeping up in CS is I ever go outside of supp. I'll very often end with half the cs of my enemy laner and I feel like its by far my biggest weakpoint.

It feels like i'm always in one of 2 scenarios. I'm trying to freeze the wave and deny them cs and they just walk up for free and get all of it and if i try to poke/posture them away I just get ganked every time, or I hyper push into their tower and roam only for them to get every minion under tower and I achieve nothing in the process.

Are there resources to improve specifically on this aspect or some simple tips that i'm not considering? I know a lot of it is map awareness and knowing where their jg is and where roaming would be most efficient, i pretty much depend on vision to know where any enemy is at any given time and don't know how to become better at predicting enemy movement, i seem to always guess wrong and get caught out.

since I'm looking to start going mid/top I'd also welcome any champ recommendations that make this easier. (side note: im looking to start playing a champ that works better with my duo who plays heca jg)

--- TOP COMMENTS ---

[Comment 1 | Score: 3]

How many champs are you playing, are you trying to improve at other things at the same time, and how distracted are you in a game? Btw, duoq is not for improvement and will also hinder you while you try to improve. If you want to play duoq with your friend while you try to improve you can but you have to do everything else right and just know it will still take quite a bit longer.

[Comment 2 | Score: 3]

If you're freezing and they can just walk up and farm as if you aren't there then you probably aren't in a position to freeze.

You freeze when you have a lead and can just brute force your opponent off the wave, naturally he will call for the jungler and you have to fight 3v1 if you include the stacked wave,

Work on understanding slow/fast pushes first, freezing is such a realistically niche topic that it isn't something to concern yourself with when you're just starting to learn, whereas literally every single wave is either a fast or a slow push.

It's really something you have to learn for support as well, not knowing the first thing about waves is so detrimental to your overall success yet even in Emerald/Low Dia it's still genuinely rare for a support to make the right call on a wave.

Specifically for your post, fast pushing does exactly what you say, it delivers the whole wave to them for free without giving you an opportunity to punish while slow pushing gives them time for the jungler to set up. Wave control is simply about knowing what the ups and downs are of 3 basic tools and then applying them well.

Search for wave control on youtube and you'll find a wealth of videos for each.

[Comment 3 | Score: 1]

>I'm trying to freeze the wave and deny them cs and they just walk up for free and get all of it

you should be freezing when you're strong enough to punish them for it or when your lane is gankable. freezing is also not nearly as OP as it used to be, you really don't need to do it that often, if at all.

>if i try to poke/posture them away I just get ganked every time

as support you should already be pretty good at keeping track of where everybody is, if not then that's something to improve on. also, if you're freezing wave, you can posture aggressively without overextending, you just can't commit to the all-in.

most champions that are viable in mid or top have a mobility spell or CC spell that they can use to easily avoid a gank - just don't use it if you think enemy jungler is sitting outside of vision on your side of the map.

>or I hyper push into their tower and roam only for them to get every minion under tower and I achieve nothing in the process

no but you did - you got prio, allowing you to roam or recall while they are stuck lasthitting.

>i pretty much depend on vision to know where any enemy is at any given time and don't know

how to become better at predicting enemy movement

for junglers, when they show up on the map you press tab to see how many jungle camps they have taken (4 cs = 1 camp) and you pan your camera over to see which buff they have, you use that to deduce which of their camps are up and which way they are most likely pathing. with experience you should learn to gauge how quickly different junglers clear their camps to know on what timings you can reasonably expect a gank (or check [jungle clear spreadsheet](<https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1jE8bnlnlJnmWv9pnVW9veMKRXJNaaJf5tneQB3xUkbl/>))

I find that in your elo junglers are actually the most predictable because they try to play optimally, meanwhile in low elo they run around the map like headless chickens while in high elo they intentionally go for weird pathing to catch you on an off timing (insert bell curve meme)

[Comment 4 | Score: 1]

Wave management is really situational, in midlane freezing only makes sense when really early into the game when you want to kill them in an all in or make them scared of ganks, later on mages just push the wave for free and assassins just roam.

As for top, freezes are really powerful because walking up that far into the lane as a melee is incredibly dangerous:

If your champ like short trades: you can take them for free with the safety of your tower

If your champ like All-ins, you can force your opponent to walk up the lane and have plenty of room to take a long extended fights

All the while you are 100% safe from ganks while the enemy has to be careful. Its really op

Now the thing is ****you dont have to "punish" right away**** if your wave is frozen just focus on damaging the enemy minions just as much as their are damaging yours, that way he can never fully push the wave and you can keep them in an uncomfortable position, only go in when you know that is safe to do so (aka you saw enemy jg/mid/supp somewhere else in the map)

Freezing is tricky tho, you will need to learn how to set up a wave so you can recall and keep it from crashing into your tower or slowpushing (leave a few casters), and how to trade with your enemy without building a slowpush. Most of the time what will happen is that eventually it will build into a slowpush, in that case just crash slowly into enemy tower, recall and freeze again.

[Comment 5 | Score: 1]

If you guess wrong and get caught out, make a mental note of it. After the game, watch the replay again, toggling vision from either side. Why did you guess they would go a certain way? If you had full map vision, would you still have guessed that? Toggle vision to only the enemy perspective. From the enemy perspective, where does it make sense for them to go?

Right now you are trying to pick up a new lane. That means these are all completely new experiences for you. You have yet to build up the pattern recognition, because you havent seen these patterns enough yet.